

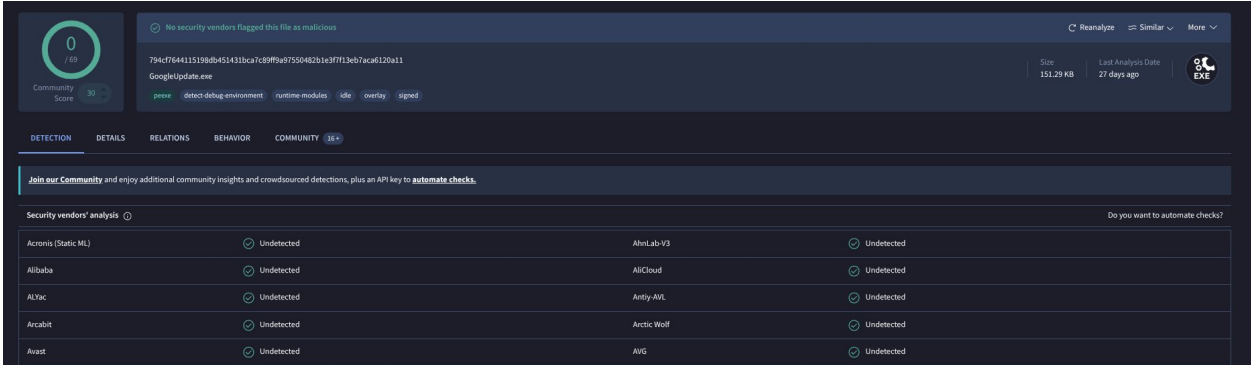
Event Information:

EventID :
57
Event Time :
Feb, 14, 2021, 11:17 AM
Rule :
SOC124 - Scheduled Task Created
Level :
Security Analyst
Source Address :
172.16.17.83
Source Hostname :
Maxim
File Name :
GoogleUpdate.exe
File Hash :
82f657b0aee67a6a560321cf0927f9f7
File Size :
151.29 KB
Device Action :
Blocked

Analysis Steps:

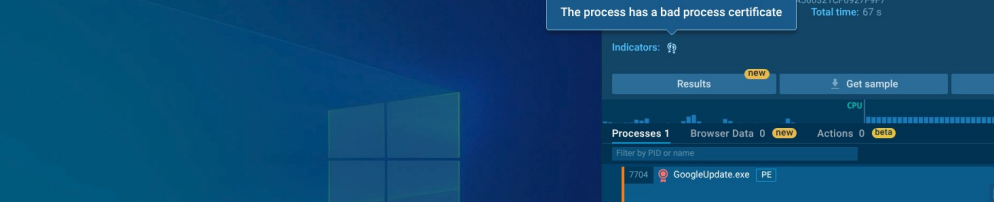
Logs were searched with attacker IP 172[.]16.17.83 (Maxim) as the source in the relevant time-frame yielding no information as to where the executable came from.

On VirusTotal the file is listed as clean and indicated to be an authentic Google signed executable as of 27 days ago.



The screenshot shows the VirusTotal analysis interface for the file GoogleUpdate.exe. The file is identified by its SHA-256 hash: 794cf644115198db451431bca7c89f9a97550482b1e3f7113eb7ac6120a11. The file size is 151.29 KB, and it was last analyzed 27 days ago. The analysis shows that no security vendors flagged this file as malicious. The file is categorized as 'peace' and has tags for 'detect debug-environment', 'runtime modules', 'idle', 'overlay', and 'signed'. The 'Security vendors' analysis table shows that all 18 vendors (Acronis, Alibaba, ALYac, Arcabit, Avast, AhnLab-V3, AliCloud, Antiy-AVL, Arctic Wolf, AVG) have detected the file as 'Undetected'. The interface also includes tabs for DETECTION, DETAILS, RELATIONS, BEHAVIOR, and COMMUNITY, and a link to join the community for more insights.

Security vendors' analysis		Do you want to automate checks?	
Acronis (Static ML)	Undetected	AhnLab-V3	Undetected
Alibaba	Undetected	AliCloud	Undetected
ALYac	Undetected	Antiy-AVL	Undetected
Arcabit	Undetected	Arctic Wolf	Undetected
Avast	Undetected	AVG	Undetected



```
Company Name           : Google LLC
File Description       : Google Installer
File Version          : 1.3.34.11
Internal Name         : Google Update
Legal Copyright       : Copyright 2018 Google LLC
Original File Name    : GoogleUpdate.exe
Product Name          : Google Update
Product Version       : 1.3.34.11
PDB Modify Date       : 2019:05:07 00:16:59+01:00
PDB Age               : 1
PDB File Name         : _GoogleUpdate_unsigned.pdb
```

PDB Modify Date : 2019:05:07 00:16:59+01:00

The alert type of “Scheduled Task Created” is also consistent with typical Google Chrome installer behaviour. It creates a Windows Scheduled Task in order to keep the browser updated.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a False Positive alert for a Scheduled Task Created on the host Maxim (172[.]16.17.83). The alert was triggered by GoogleUpdate.exe, which routinely creates scheduled tasks for browser maintenance. Sandbox environments flagged the file due to an expired digital certificate, but local static analysis and OSINT confirm the binary is a legitimate Google application.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC124 - Scheduled Task Created
- **Target Host:** Maxim (172[.]16.17.83)
- **Flagged File:** GoogleUpdate.exe
- **File Hash:** 82f657b0aee67a6a560321cf0927f9f7
- **Device Action:** Blocked

Analysis and Evidence

- **Execution:** The file attempted to create a scheduled task, which is the standard mechanism Google uses to ensure its software remains updated.
- **Local Static Analysis:** exiftool analysis reveals the file was compiled in 2019 and retains valid Google LLC metadata. Extracted strings show standard Windows API calls with no obfuscation or suspicious C2 indicators.

Threat Intelligence

- **OSINT:** VirusTotal analysis confirms a 0/69 detection rate and verifies the file as an authentic Google-signed executable.
- **Sandbox Discrepancy:** AnyRun flagged the execution as malicious citing a bad process certificate. Correlation with local static analysis proves this is a false flag caused by the natural expiration of the 2019 digital certificate.

Actions Taken

1. Verified the file hash against OSINT sources (VirusTotal), confirming a 0/69 detection rate and a legitimate signature.
2. Reviewed sandbox telemetry (AnyRun), noting the malicious flag was strictly tied to an expired process certificate.
3. Performed local static analysis (file, exiftool, strings) via a Linux terminal to verify compile timestamps and benign API imports.
4. Determined the alert is a False Positive triggered by routine software maintenance and closed the alert.

Recommendations

Detection rules should be tuned to exclude scheduled task creation by known, trusted updaters (such as GoogleUpdate.exe) to optimise SOC efficiency and reduce alert fatigue. This should also be approach with caution to avoid missing real threats.

Let's Defend Result

SOC124 - Scheduled Task Created

False Positive (+5 Point)

Analyze Malware (+5 Point)

Check if the malware is quarantined/cleaned (+5 Point)